



RESTORATIONESSENTIALS

Factory-Correct Restoration Reference

LS/LT Conversion Guide — GM F-Body 1967–1969

Model Year 2026

Recipient cars	Camaro, Firebird (1967–69 F-Body)
Donor engines	Gen III/IV LS (donor-first) · crate LS3 · Gen V LT
Highlights	Rear-steer pan plan; subframe mock-up method; worksheets
Price	\$29.95 — PDF download at checkout

Every specification in this guide was checked against factory literature, marque references, period road tests, and documented survivor cars. Where sources disagree or the record is silent, this guide says so rather than guessing.

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Chapter 1 — The Decision: Donor, Crate, or Gen V LT (Read This First)

The first-generation F-Body — 1967–69 Camaro and Firebird — is the LS swap the brochures make look easiest and the tape measure makes honest. The bay looks wide. It is also shallow, the steering linkage lives behind the crossmember exactly where an oil pan wants to be, and the whole front of the car hangs on a bolt-on subframe that decides every clearance you will fight. This chapter puts the whole bill on the table before the first bolt turns, the way this family does it for every body.

- **Donor-first (this guide's default, per the family decision):** a salvage truck 5.3 or 6.0 (LM7/LQ4 class) or — the packaging gift — a 1998–2002 Camaro/Firebird LS1 with its harness, PCM, and accessory drive. The F-body donor's drive was packaged for a low, tight bay and brings the friendliest starting point; the truck donor is the budget path and the taller one. The unknowns on any donor are mileage, accessory completeness, and harness condition — audited in Chapter 2 before money moves.
- **Crate:** a new LS3 (430 hp, GM's published rating) or a controller-package crate with its wiring and calibration. It buys certainty about the engine only. The pan, mounts, fuel, cooling, and tune below are the same bill either way.
- **Gen V LT:** the direct-injected LT1 6.2 (455 hp, GM's published rating) and its truck siblings. Newer and more efficient, and a different job — high-pressure fuel hardware, VVT/AFM behavior, Gen V accessory packaging. It gets its own chapter (Chapter 4). Bolting an LT in like an LS is the expensive way to learn the difference.

The line items first-timers miss (planning ranges, not promises — salvage and parts prices move): the retrofit oil pan and matched pickup (Chapter 3 names the documented one for this chassis); the swap mount brackets and transmission crossmember; accessory-drive correction (alternator clearance at the crossmember, Chapter 3); the EFI fuel system end to end; radiator, shroud, and fans; the harness (reworked donor vs standalone) and the PCM edits; headers that clear the steering box; a driveshaft re-measurement after the crossmember moves; and the tune. Restoring this car first? The RestoreEssentials restoration guides for 1967, 1968, and 1969 Camaro and for 1967, 1968, and 1969 Firebird are the companion volumes — restore it with those, convert it with this one. If the honest total busts the budget, finishing the car with its original drivetrain beats a stalled swap at every cruise night on earth.



Note. If you only have \$X: spend it in this order — (1) the right pan and mounts for this subframe, (2) the fuel system done once at full pressure spec, (3) cooling, (4) the PCM edits, (5) cosmetics. A swap that starts, cools, and charges on day one can be dressed for a decade. A pretty engine that boils in traffic is yard art with license plates.

Chapter 2 — What You Start With: The F-Body Baseline

Inspect the recipient car before the donor engine gets purchased. Pass/fail criteria, not vibes:

- **Subframe condition:** the front subframe is removable, which makes it inspectable. Mounting holes elongated, crossmember damage, and rot at the body-mount faces = repair or replace the subframe first. Everything you bolt to it inherits its truth.
- **Steering identity:** manual or power box, and the rear-steer center link behind the crossmember. The link's position is the pan-clearance referee (Chapter 3). Note the box ratio if known — a quick-ratio box is a shakedown improvement, not a fitment fix.
- **Body structure:** rocker and floor condition where subframe connectors would land, if you plan them. Higher-torque donors twist a unibody that was adequate for a 1967 small-block; connectors are a documented stiffening step, and convertibles start with the least structure of all. Decide with the donor's torque in the picture, honestly.
- **Firewall:** whether the car carries the factory A/C evaporator case on the passenger side. It shapes the header shortlist (Chapter 8) and your A/C future. Measure it; photograph it.
- **Ride height:** record it as the car will be driven. Driveshaft length and pinion angle are measured at final height (Worksheet A); springs you plan to change change every number after them.
- **The donor audit** (family discipline): compression or a running demonstration, oil condition, and a signed accessory inventory — alternator, starter, power-steering pump, MAF, drive-by-wire pedal where applicable, PCM, harness completeness. 'Complete pullout' is a sales phrase; the checklist is the contract.

Chapter 3 — Fitment: Putting an LS in a 1967–69 F-Body

The engine lives in the subframe, so the subframe sets the rules. Swap bracket systems for this chassis (the Hooker Blackheart 12618HKR class) are documented as a bolt-in family: brackets, transmission crossmembers, headers, Holley pans, and Holley accessory drives designed to work together. Mixing mount systems casually is how clearances that were engineered away come back. Pick a system, use its documentation as the baseline, and measure your car against it.

Oil pan — the F-body's first gotcha, handled here because it referees everything else. Rear-steer linkage behind the crossmember leaves no room for a deep front pan section. The documented bolt-in-compatible answers with the Blackheart brackets are the Holley 302-2 F-body retrofit pan, a notched stock F-body pan, and fabricated steel pans of the same envelope. The Holley 302-1 also installs but requires notching the engine crossmember for its stroker-capable front dimensions — a permanent modification to fix a parts choice; the 302-2 exists so you don't. 302-2 specifics from Holley's documentation: maximum crank stroke 3.62 in (no LS7, no big-stroker builds), 5.7-quart sump (6.2 total with filter), GM F-body windage tray 12558253 with the documented pickup-clearance modification (or a full tray with the front quarter removed), and Holley 302-15 or LS3 dipstick/tube (GM 12669528/12625031). MEASURE ON YOUR CAR: pan-to-center-link clearance at full steering lock in both directions, engine at final mount height — Holley's own notes warn the engine position may need up/down or fore/aft adjustment depending on steering configuration.



Accessory drive. F-body, GTO, and Corvette drives are all documented as installable on the swap brackets — with named caveats, which is why this is a mock-up chapter and not a shopping list. Low-mount alternators require notching or clearancing the engine crossmember. The stock plastic shroud on the rear of the F-body alternator may need modification or removal. A GTO alternator may need swapping to an F-body alternator for maximum clearance. A Corvette drive's power-steering pump pulley will likely need a smaller pulley or pump to clear the upper control arm. And the A-body lesson holds here word for word: stock low-mount A/C compressors are not installable with these mounts — the compressor upper-mounts to the right cylinder head (Holley 20-133 for the GM R4, 20-134 for Sanden SD508/SD7 class), unless you fabricate a custom bracket further back on the subframe as the documented exception. Decide A/C before the engine lands (Chapter 8).

Transmission and crossmember. The 4L60E-class overdrive is the common fit; swap crossmembers relocate rearward for it, and the driveshaft is re-measured to your car afterward — crossmember movement figures in videos and threads are starting points for someone else's transmission and mount stack, never your order number. The 4L80E, 6L80, and the big-case manuals (T56 and TR-6060 class) get MEASURED against your tunnel (Worksheet B), never assumed: tunnel work on a unibody is permanent, so it is the last resort, chosen knowingly, after transmission choice and crossmember selection have had their say.

Chapter 4 — The Gen V LT Chapter: Direct Injection Changes the Job

The Gen V LT (LT1 6.2, 455 hp published; L83 5.3 and L86 6.2 in trucks; LT4 supercharged at 650 hp published) bolts to the same mount conversation and brings four differences that change the plan:

- **Direct injection:** a cam-driven high-pressure pump feeds the rails, and the low-pressure supply side still has to hold its specification at full load. DI fittings are not hose-clamp territory. Chapter 6's discipline applies double.
- **VVT and AFM:** variable valve timing and cylinder deactivation live in the Gen V calibration. Keeping, locking, or deleting AFM is a Chapter 9 decision with hardware consequences (lifters), not a surprise at the first oil change.
- **Accessory packaging:** Gen V drives and vacuum management differ from the LS. The swap-bracket market addresses LT separately — do not buy LS brackets for an LT and discover it at mock-up.
- **Electronics:** Gen V controllers (E92 family) and their security are a different programming conversation from the Gen III/IV PCMs. The standalone or factory control-package decision (Chapter 5) is usually easier on an LT, and this chapter says so plainly.

Who should choose the LT: the buyer who wants the newest engine, accepts the electronics depth, and budgets the control package as part of the engine price. Who shouldn't: the first-timer on a tight budget — the Gen III truck donor path in Chapter 1 exists for him, and it finishes.

Chapter 5 — Wiring and Controls

The three harness strategies. (1) Reworked donor harness: cheapest, and it demands the discipline to thin it correctly; the donor's fuse/relay architecture comes along or gets rebuilt deliberately. (2) Standalone swap harness: labeled, fused, built for the conversion — the budget line that buys weekends back. (3) Full engine-management systems when the build outgrows the factory PCM's brief: cam, boost, or features the stock computer shouldn't be asked to fake.

The PCM edit list every factory-computer swap needs (documented across the swap literature): VATS/passkey security deleted — without it the PCM will not run the pump, coils, or injectors and the engine cranks forever in perfect health; rear oxygen sensors and the donor's emissions monitors addressed; tachometer output scaled to the classic gauge (the cylinder-count signal issue); vehicle-speed output scaled to the



speedometer solution you chose; electric-fan outputs enabled (truck PCMs did not drive electric fans from the factory); and the throttle decision — cable (early Gen III) or drive-by-wire with its matched pedal — programmed to match the hardware. Gauges: classic senders thread into LS ports with adapters; keep the temperature sender honest and the oil-pressure sender matched to the gauge, not the donor.

Note. Safety: battery disconnected for every harness step. ECM grounds go to clean engine metal, never to a painted bracket — ground-strap discipline is the modern ECU's favorite failure, and a swap with 'electrical gremlins' usually has three grounds sharing one corroded bolt.

Chapter 6 — The Fuel System: 58 Pounds of Non-Negotiable

The carburetor's mechanical pump and low-pressure line end here. LS EFI runs at a regulated 58 psi at the rail (published requirements cluster at 58–62 psi across MSD, FiTech, Edelbrock, and Blueprint documentation), fed by a pump flowing on the order of 240–340 liters per hour at pressure (Blueprint's published specification), through filtration staged around the pump (100-micron pre-filter, 10–30-micron post-filter for inline setups, per the same documentation). The architectures:

- **EFI tank module:** a swap tank with an in-tank pump and regulator — quiet, cooled by fuel, and the clean-sheet answer this guide recommends for a car being built once.
- **Inline pump with the stock tank:** workable, with a sump/baffle plan for cornering starvation, the filter stages above, and a return line sized to where the regulator lives (rail-mounted on early engines; filter/regulator combinations on returnless-style builds).
- **Lines:** EFI-rated hose or hard line throughout, routed away from exhaust heat, with the tank vented deliberately — venting is a fuel-system item with its own gotcha in Chapter 10, not an afterthought.

Note. Safety, plainly: 58 psi of gasoline finds every loose fitting at first prime. Prime the system with the coils unplugged, inspect every joint with a light and a dry hand, and keep a fire extinguisher — not a garden hose — within reach of the first start. There is no small gasoline leak. Do not road-test a car with a weeping fitting.

Chapter 7 — Cooling and the Steam Lines

Sizing logic, not folklore: the radiator must shed the new engine's heat at idle in traffic, with the A/C on if the car will have it. Crossflow aluminum radiators and electric fans in a sealed shroud are the market's answer, and the fan decision is electrical (Chapter 5's fan outputs, Chapter 2's charging capacity) as much as airflow. The swap-specific item is the steam-vent system: LS heads trap steam at the high corners, and the factory vent lines exist for that reason. Plumb the vents to the radiator or the pressurized side per your radiator's provisions. An LS that 'runs hot only sometimes' is very often an unvented steam pocket introducing itself. Diagnosis order for a hot swap: steam plumbing, fan trigger temperatures in the tune, shroud sealing, then parts — the first three are free to check.

Chapter 8 — Exhaust: Headers, the Steering Box, and the A/C Decision

Two F-body facts organize this chapter. First, the driver's header and the steering box both want the space along the subframe rail: swap-specific headers for this chassis are engineered around that box, and the measurement happens at mock-up with the box installed (Worksheet B), never from a catalog photograph. Second, the A/C decision precedes the engine going in: with swap mounts, the stock low-mount compressor is not installable (Chapter 3), so a car that will have air gets the upper-mount bracket plan now, and a car with the factory evaporator case on the firewall checks its header shortlist against that case before ordering. Where manifolds clear, this guide says honestly what they cost: some power, in exchange for clearing everything and never cracking. On a street-driven first-gen car that trade is often the right one. Ground clearance with long-tubes on a lowered car is MEASURED ON YOUR CAR at final ride height.

Chapter 9 — ECU and Tuning Decisions

The decision tree, not brand loyalty:

- **Stock PCM, edited:** the Chapter 5 edit list on a stock or near-stock engine — the cheapest correct answer, and the right one for a donor-fresh build.
- **Stock PCM, dyno tune:** required when the engine's airflow story changes — cam, heads, forced induction. A mail-order tune can delete security and set fans; it cannot know your cam.
- **Standalone management:** when the build combines boost, transmission control, and features beyond the stock computer's brief, or on Gen V LT builds where the controller conversation is harder (Chapter 4).
- **Locked vs unlocked:** a swap PCM with security still intact is a locked computer wearing a disguise. Verify VATS status before first-start day; Chapter 13's checklist assumes it.

What a tune cannot fix: low fuel pressure (Chapter 6), a steam-pocket cooling problem (Chapter 7), a slipping clutch, or a driveshaft angle (Worksheet A). The tune is the last system finished, not the first excuse used.

Chapter 10 — The Gotchas

Each gotcha in the family's fixed format: *What happens / Why it happens / How to see it coming / The fix, in order of cost*. Every category the family grades is here; where a category is clear on this body, it says so in one line.

- **Oil pan vs the rear-steer center link.** *What:* the pan meets the center link at steering lock, or sits on the crossmember. *Why:* truck and deep-front pans were shaped for chassis whose linkage lives somewhere else. *See it:* mock-up at full lock, both ways, engine at final mount height (Chapter 3). *Fix, in cost order:* engine position adjustment within the mount system; the documented 302-2-class retrofit pan with matched pickup and tray; a fabricated pan of the same envelope. Notching the crossmember to save a pan choice is permanent work spent on the wrong line item.
- **The low-mount alternator vs the crossmember.** *What:* the alternator and the crossmember occupy the same inches. *Why:* low-mount brackets put it there. *See it:* Chapter 3's drive identification before purchase, and the mock-up with the drive complete. *Fix:* the documented clearancing for the F-body alternator (including its rear shroud), the F-body alternator in place of a GTO unit, or a drive swap — in that order.
- **Corvette drive vs the upper control arm.** *What:* the power-steering pulley meets the upper control arm. *Why:* the Corvette drive is compact front-to-back, not top-to-bottom. *See it:* documented in the bracket instructions; verify at mock-up. *Fix:* the smaller pulley or pump the documentation calls for.
- **The low-mount A/C compressor.** *What:* the donor compressor and the subframe disagree. *Why:* swap mounts put the engine where the compressor can't be. *See it:* Chapter 3 and Chapter 8 — before the engine lands. *Fix:* upper-mount bracket (20-133/20-134 class); the fabricated rearward bracket as the documented



last resort.

- **Header vs steering box.** *What:* the driver's header meets the box or the shaft. *Why:* both were given the same rail-side real estate. *See it:* Worksheet B at mock-up, box and shaft installed. *Fix:* chassis-specific swap headers; or the manifolds that clear everything, accepting Chapter 8's honest trade.
- **Big transmission vs the tunnel.** *What:* 4L80E/6L80/T56-class cases can need floor relief. *Why:* the tunnel was drawn around 1967 cases. *See it:* Worksheet B measurements against the transmission's published dimensions. *Fix:* transmission choice first, crossmember position second, tunnel work last — permanent is last, and on a unibody it is structural.
- **Throttle-pedal geometry (drive-by-wire).** *What:* a DBW pedal mounted at the wrong angle drives lazy or touchy forever. *Why:* the PCM reads pedal angle, not effort. *See it:* mock the pedal position and verify full travel before final mounting. *Fix:* reposition the pedal. No tune cures geometry.
- **Fuel-tank venting.** *What:* fuel smell, tank pressure, starvation. *Why:* the carbureted tank vented for low-pressure drama, not 58 psi. *See it:* Chapter 6's vent plan. *Fix:* a deliberate vent/rollover path routed correctly; a charcoal canister where the build keeps one.
- **Donor accessory completeness.** *What:* the 'complete pullout' lacks the alternator, the pedal, the MAF, or the PCM. *Why:* 'complete' is a sales word. *See it:* Chapter 2's signed checklist. *Fix:* inside the negotiation, never after it.
- **The crossmember moved and the shaft didn't.** *What:* vibration, or a shaft ordered to a number from a video. *Why:* overdrive swaps relocate the crossmember and change the output position. *See it:* Worksheet A, measured at final ride height after the crossmember is final. *Fix:* a shaft built to your measurement; angle correction per the drivetrain guides.
- **Steam pockets.** Covered in Chapter 7 — graded here: applies to every LS/LT swap; vent the heads.
- **Checked — clear on this body:** shock towers (the F-body has none to notch); the firewall evaporator case is a header-selection check (Chapter 8), not a structural modification.

Chapter 11 — Tips and Tricks

- **Plan on three engine installations:** mock-up, clearance-check, final. The builders who do it once planned on three and got lucky twice — especially on this chassis, where the pan, the link, and the alternator all vote.
- **Use the subframe.** It unbolts. Mock-up and drive-fitting on the cradle, out from under the car, is this body's one great kindness; take it.
- **Test-fit the accessory drive before final torque** on the mounts. Belts and brackets are cheaper to rearrange on the stand than over a painted subframe.
- **Bag and tag the donor teardown.** The connector you cut 'because it looked unused' is the one the PCM wants.
- **Photograph every routing decision.** Heat and chafe are patient enemies, and the photo is the map at the first repair.
- **Chase threads before torque values.** Fifty-year-old subframe threads lie to torque wrenches.



Chapter 12 — Special Tools

Must-have: an engine hoist with a leveler (the leveler matters more than the hoist upgrade — the engine goes in at an angle, low, between the fenders), rated jack stands you trust, a fuel-pressure gauge that reads 100 psi (Chapter 6's verification is not optional), a multimeter, and thread chasers for the subframe's fastener sizes. **Rent or borrow:** the transmission jack, the harmonic-balancer puller/installer, the flare tool if hard lines are being bent. **Nice:** a lift — it converts Chapter 13's under-car checks from an afternoon to an hour. No tool is listed here without the chapter that uses it.

Chapter 13 — First Start and Shakedown

- **Before cranking:** fuel system primed and leak-checked (Chapter 6's discipline); cooling filled with steam vents verified; oil primed per the engine's procedure; PCM security status confirmed (Chapter 9); battery charged; extinguisher in reach.
- **First start:** one person at the key, one at the engine bay with a light. Short cranks. Watch oil pressure like it is the only gauge — today, it is.
- **First heat cycle:** fan trigger verified against a real temperature reading; steam vents re-checked; every fastener you torqued gets its re-check after cool-down where the service literature calls for it.
- **50 miles:** leaks, belts, harness chafe, driveline report (Worksheet A if it vibrates). **500 miles:** re-torque list, fluid levels, alignment after springs settle — and the honest Chapter 9 conversation about what the tune still owes you.

Note. Safety, plainly: do not road-test the car until the brakes have been verified at walking pace and then neighborhood pace — a swapped car has different weight and different pedal feel, and the first stop is a test, not a commute. Steering fasteners disturbed during the swap are single-use-critical: replace or re-torque per the factory literature, never 'snug by feel.'

Appendix: Worksheets (Fill These In On YOUR Car)

Worksheet A — Driveline. Ride height (four corners, as the car will be driven): _____. Transmission output angle: _____. Pinion angle: _____. Working angles computed: _____. Shaft length, center-to-center at ride height, AFTER the crossmember is in its final position: _____. (The drivetrain family's shaft-and-geometry guide owns the targets; these blanks own your car.)

Worksheet B — Tunnel and clearance. Transmission chosen: _____. Bellhousing-to-floor clearance at the closest point: _____. Crossmember used: _____. Pan-to-center-link clearance at full lock L/R: ____ / _____. Alternator-to-crossmember clearance: _____. Power-steering pulley-to-upper-control-arm clearance: _____. Header-to-steering-box clearance: _____. Firewall A/C case present (Y/N) and header clearance to it: _____.

Worksheet C — Parts-total ledger. Engine/donor: _____. Pan/pickup/mounts/crossmember: _____. Accessory drive and brackets: _____. Fuel system: _____. Cooling: _____. Harness/PCM/tune: _____. Exhaust: _____. Transmission and driveshaft: _____. Gauges and small parts: _____. Subframe connectors if planned: _____. Total, honest: _____. Compare it to the crate quote and to finishing the car with its original drivetrain before Chapter 1's decision is final — that comparison is the decision.



Recommended for this restoration

Shop exact-fit supplies on Amazon

- LS swap 1967-1969 Camaro Firebird mount kit Hooker Blackheart
- Holley LS retrofit oil pan 302-2 F-body
- LS swap EFI fuel tank kit 1967-1969 Camaro
- LS standalone wiring harness 1967-1969 Camaro

As an Amazon Associate, RestorationEssentials earns from qualifying purchases made through these links.

Sources Consulted

Every specification in this guide was checked against published references before printing. Where sources disagree, this guide says so in the text rather than picking a number silently. The references below are the backbone of the technical chapters:

- **Hooker Blackheart installation instructions (12618HKR class).** 1967–69 F-body / 1968–74 X-body LS swap engine brackets: the documented bolt-in compatibility list (Holley 302-2 pan, notched stock F-body pan, fabricated pans), the 302-1 crossmember-notch condition, accessory-drive caveats (low-mount alternator clearancing, F-body alternator shroud, GTO-to-F-body alternator swap, Corvette power-steering pulley), and the low-mount A/C compressor exclusion with the 20-133/20-134 upper-mount answer
- **Holley 302-1 / 302-2 oil-pan documentation.** retrofit pan applications for 1967–69 Camaro/Firebird, the rear-steer clearance design, 3.62-inch stroke limit, capacities, the GM 12558253 windage-tray requirement and modification, and the 302-15 / GM 12669528 / 12625031 dipstick specifications
- **GM LS-family production data.** engine RPO applications and factory ratings for Gen III, Gen IV, and Gen V engines as published in GM engine-family references
- **EFI system manufacturers' installation literature.** fuel-pressure and filtration requirements as published by MSD, FiTech, Edelbrock, and BluePrint Engines
- **GM F-platform documentation and marque references.** 1967–69 Camaro/Firebird unibody and bolt-on subframe construction, rear-steer linkage layout, and subframe-connector practice on higher-torque builds

A note on numbers. Factory literature, period road tests, and marque historians do not always agree — production totals, horsepower ratings, and paint codes all have documented conflicts. This guide uses the best-supported figure in each case and flags the conflict where one exists, so you can judge for yourself.

Emissions legality varies by jurisdiction: this guide explains what the factory-systems people in your state will ask; it cannot guarantee any conversion passes anywhere. Structural rust repair belongs to the restoration guides and to body shops; forced induction beyond the factory-supercharged engines named here is outside this guide's scope.



Thank You

Thank you for choosing this RestorationEssentials guide. Whether this is your first LS/LT Conversion — GM F-Body 1967–1969 or your fiftieth, you picked one of the great ones, and the fact that you are doing your homework before you turn a wrench puts you ahead of most of the field.

These cars survived because people like you refused to let them disappear. Every correct fastener, every properly decoded tag, every hour spent getting the details right keeps the history honest for the next owner and the next generation of enthusiasts.

Modern engine, first-generation car — planned before the first wrench turned. Measure on your car, write it in the worksheets, and finish it: a finished swap beats a perfect plan every Saturday night.

If this guide helped your build, we would love to hear about it. Good luck with the restoration, and enjoy every mile.

— The RestorationEssentials Team